

Do bureaucrats vote for the dictatorships that employ them?

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Research question

Authoritarians occasionally do elections, some of these are competitive
Bureaucrats are relatively easier voters to coerce

We might think bureaucrats will not risk their jobs by working against their employer. However, bureaucrats may:

1. Genuinely not like the government they work for
2. Believe they will keep their job after a transition
3. See the impacts of authoritarianism in their personal lives; voting is relational

There is little evidence that secret ballots are violated ()

Motivation

Whether bureaucrats vote for authoritarians or not matters because (old) evidence suggests that bureaucrats have higher turnout rates

Therefore, bureaucrats can shape close elections, and become an important support for democratic outcomes

Hypotheses

1. Alternative incentives: State employment does not guarantee support for the incumbent, even under authoritarianism
2. Rank-based heterogeneous effects: Higher-rank bureaucrats are more likely to vote for the incumbent than lower-rank bureaucrats
 - They have more to lose after a transition

Context

In 1988, there was a plebiscite in Chile asking whether citizens wanted the continuation of the dictatorship or not

YES - Vote in favor of Pinochet staying

NO - Vote to change leaders → democratization

With nearly 56%, Pinochet lost and Chile has been a democracy ever since

Data

1. 1992 census data

The census asks municipality of residence in 1987, one year before the plebiscite. It also asks occupation, years of school and education type
I created municipality-level proportions

2. 1988 municipality-level voting records

Municipality-level voting data from the National Electoral Service (SERVEL), as well municipality-level control variables from Bautista et al. (2021)

Analysis

I am using OLS regressions with:

- Weights by municipality population
- Province fixed effects
- CR2 standard errors

Controls: Logged distance to regional capital, share of left-wing votes in the latest democratic election (1970), population, share of victims across time relative to 1970 population

First specification: Bureaucrats

$$Y_m = \alpha + \beta(\text{Prop. Bureaucrat})_m + X_m + \lambda_p + \varepsilon_m$$

Tests *alternative incentives*: State employment does not guarantee electoral support for the regime

Expectation: The population of bureaucrats in the municipality should have no effect in the dictatorship's voteshare

Second specification

$$Y_m = \alpha + \beta_1(\text{Share High Rank B.})_m + \beta_2(\text{Share Mid Rank B.})_m + X_m + \lambda_p + \varepsilon_m$$

Rank variables based on years of schooling:

- High-rank: College or more
- Mid-rank: High school or more
- Low-rank: Did not start high school

Tests *heterogeneous effects* → State employment does not guarantee electoral support for the regime

Expectation: The high-rank coefficient should be positive

Identification

Relies on conditional ignorability:

I assume that conditional on my controls, the *proportion of bureaucrats* among the municipality population and *the rank-composition of the bureaucracy* is as if random

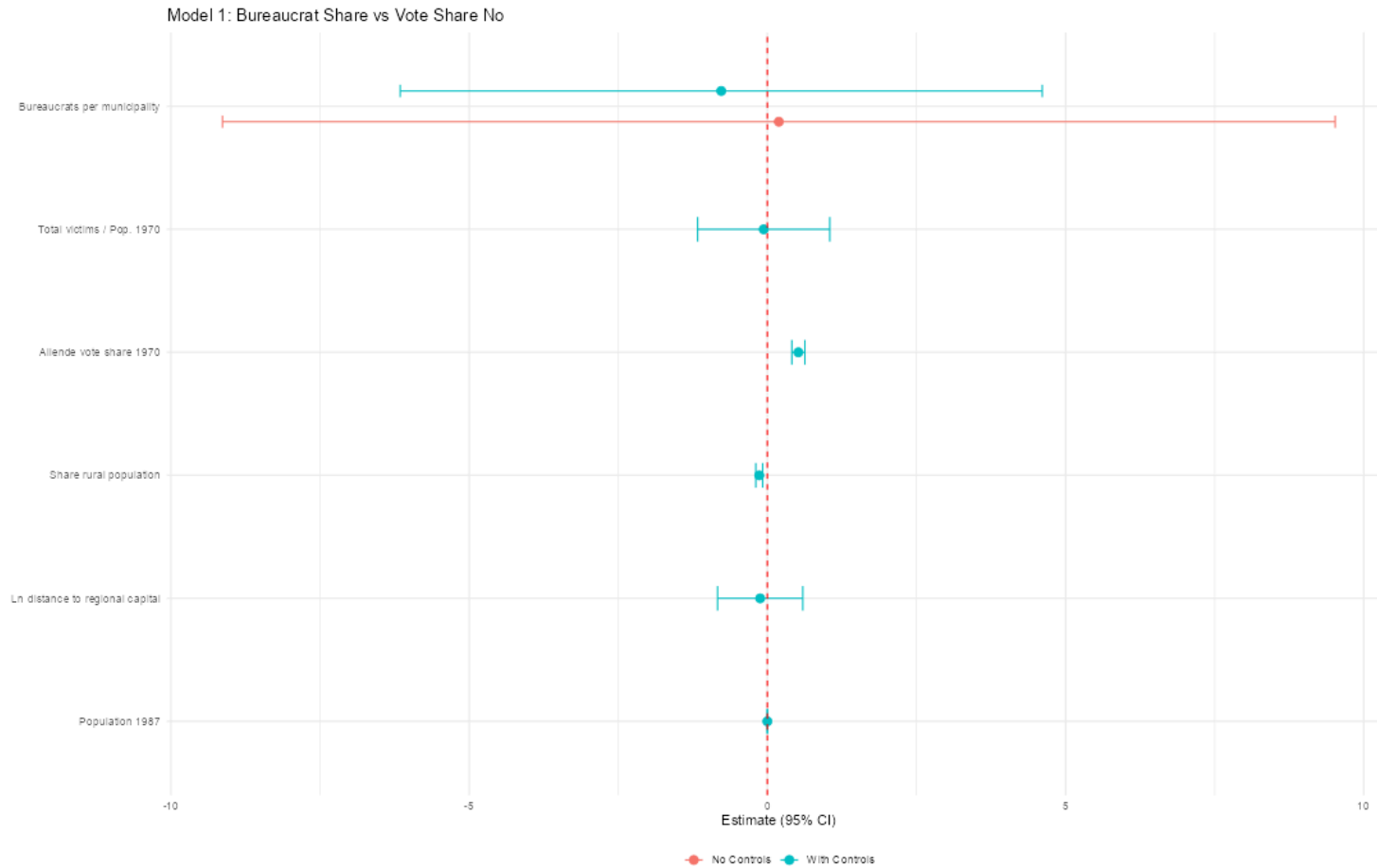
I assume no unmeasured confounding (difficult)

- I do sensitivity tests at the end

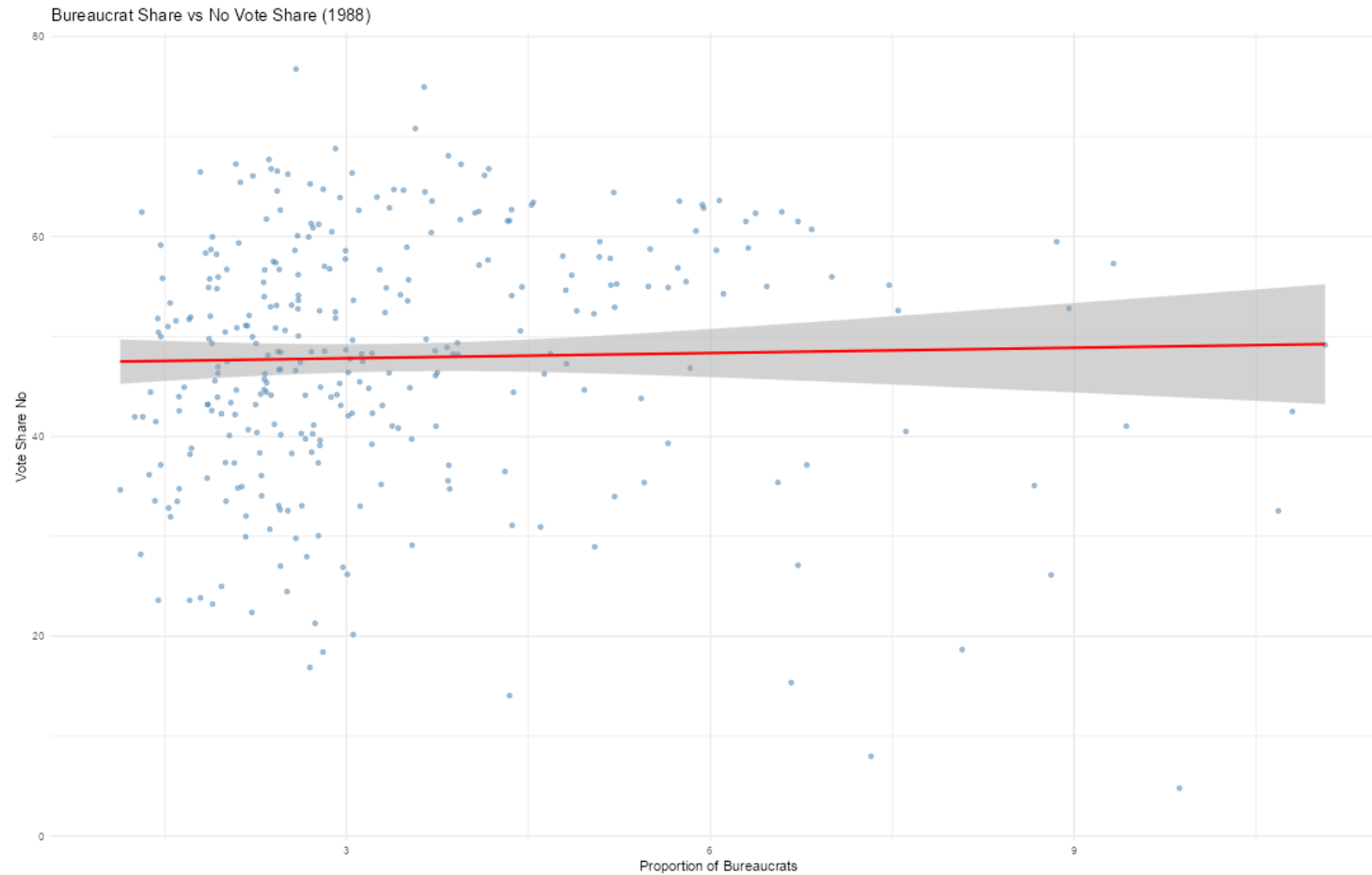
Results of both hypotheses

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Proportion of bureaucrats	0.1926 (1.4402)	-0.7733 (0.7593)		
High rank share			0.7006 (0.0850)	0.3028 (0.0988)
Mid rank share			1.1458 (0.2149)	0.4427 (0.0908)
Num.Obs.	274	269	274	269
R2	0.389	0.809	0.558	0.795

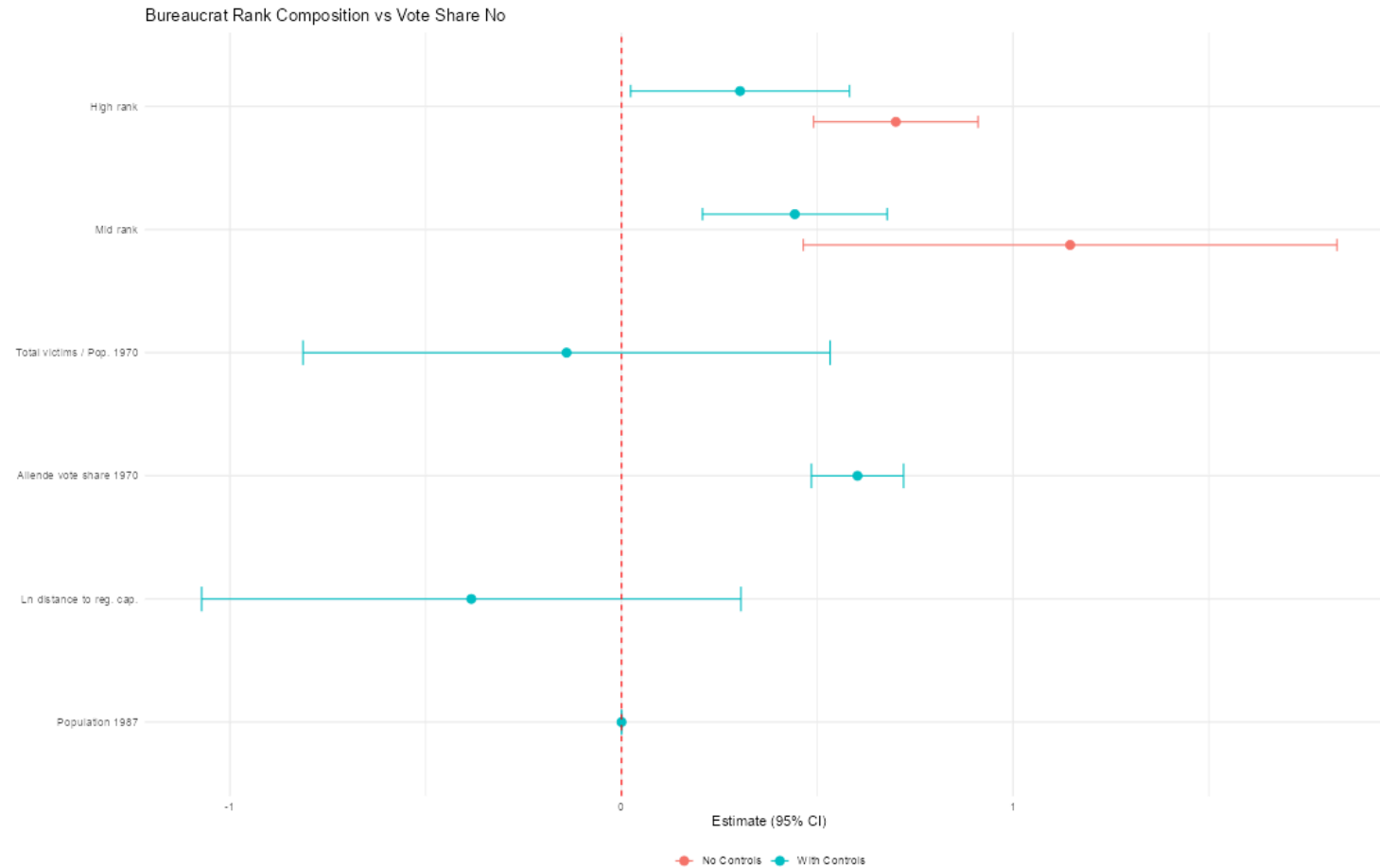
Results: Alternative incentives



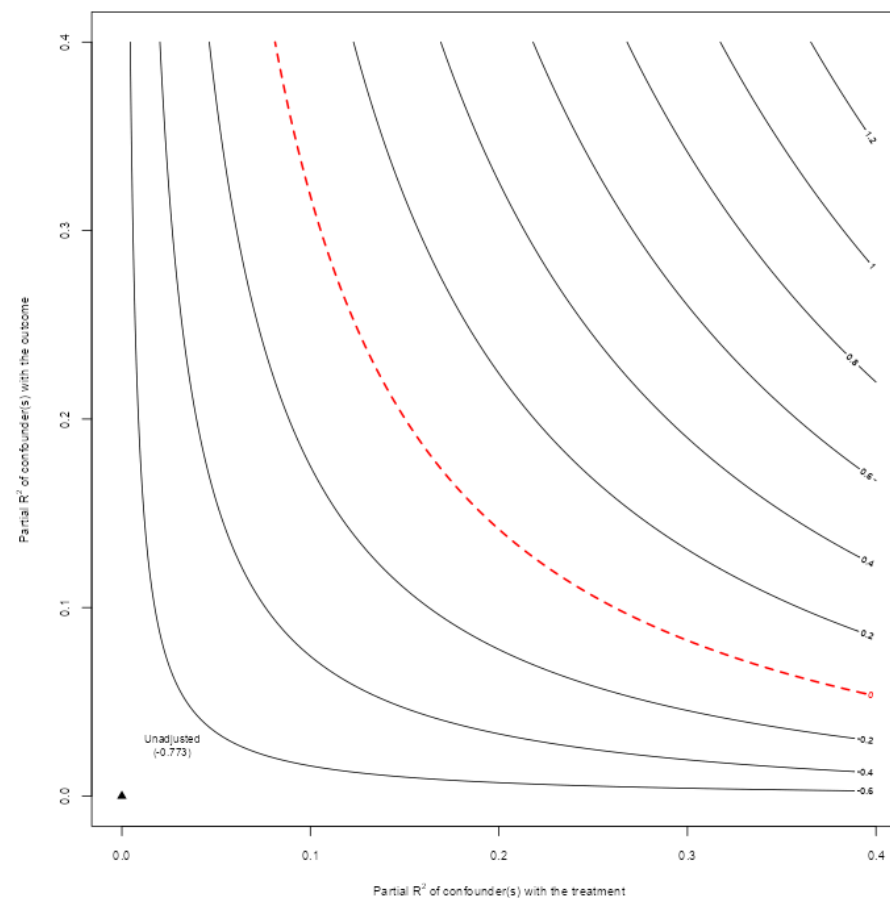
Results: Alternative incentives



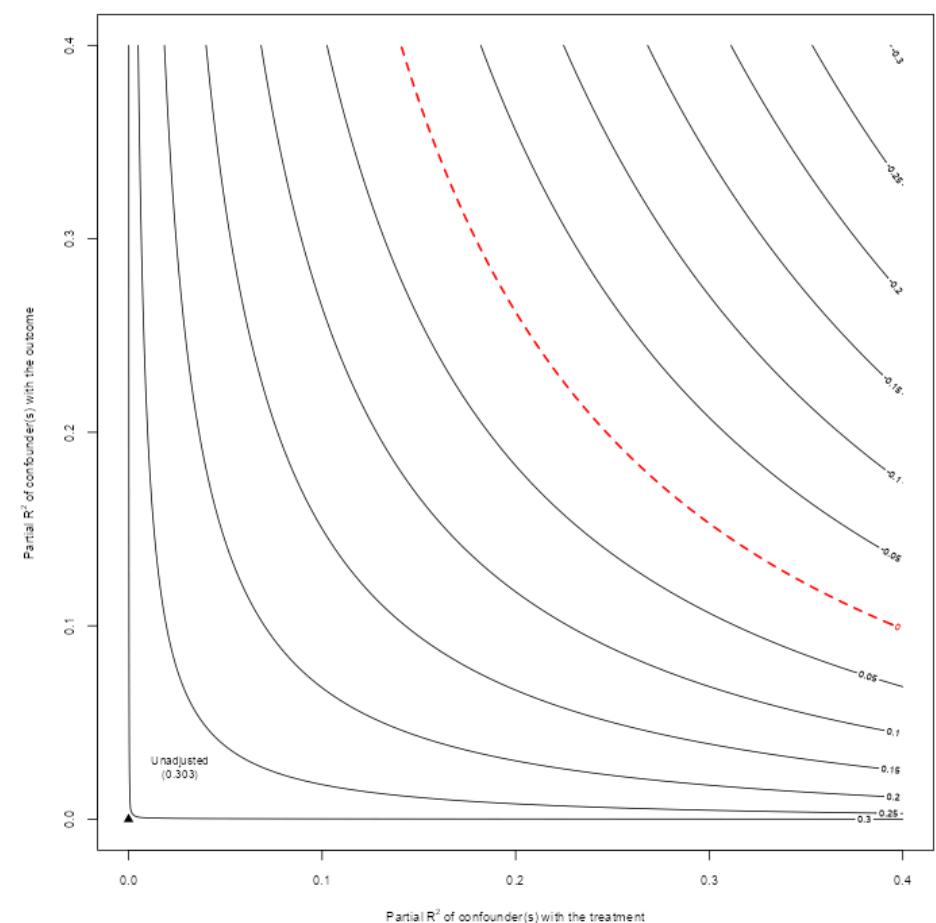
Results: Rank-based heterogeneous effects



Sensitivity tests: Alternative incentives



Sensitivity tests: Rank-based heterogeneous effects



Problems

1. Some of my covariates are post-treatment
2. It's hard to disentangle mechanisms for the difference between ranks.
E.g. Higher-rank bureaucrats not only have more to lose, they also have more information

Questions/feedback

1. What other unmeasured confounders can you think of?
2. I really care about the relational side of voting. How do I measure that?

Thanks!

Extras

Balance table

	Mean	SD	Min	Max	N
No vote share	47.63	12.80	3.26	76.77	336
Allende vote share 1970	35.21	13.22	4.17	76.78	324
Proportion of bureaucrats	3.39	1.83	1.06	11.07	317
High rank bureaucrats	1.67	1.14	0.28	9.17	317
Mid rank bureaucrats	1.23	0.81	0.31	7.02	317
High rank share among bureaucrats	48.26	9.49	13.33	91.23	317
Mid rank share among bureaucrats	35.67	7.75	7.20	63.45	317
Total victims / Pop. 1970	2.45	8.55	0.00	132.72	291
Military presence	0.11	0.32	0.00	1.00	342
Ln distance to regional capital	3.72	1.40	0.00	7.11	342
Population 1987	34460.12	51160.04	218.00	299983.00	317
Share rural population 1970	53.04	31.46	0.00	100.44	331

Heterogenous effects, other specification

